

ATS FOR CANDIDATES

UI/UX Standards Context Document

CS 490 Capstone — Spring 2026 | Wagwonn Generals

1. Navigation Model

Fixed left sidebar on desktop. Collapses to bottom tab bar below 768px. This pattern does not change across sprints.

Sidebar width	240px expanded / 64px icon-only collapsed
Primary destinations	Dashboard → Document Library → Profile → Settings
Active state	Filled accent background — always visible, never ambiguous
Mobile (< 768px)	Sidebar hidden — four icons in a fixed bottom tab bar

No additional top-level nav items without full team agreement. No sub-navigation in Sprint 1.

2. Dashboard Interaction Model

Vertical scrollable card list, grouped by pipeline stage. Chosen over Kanban for density and scale. This paradigm is locked — do not switch mid-project.

Job card (compact)	Title, company, location, stage badge, last activity date
Expansion	Click card to expand inline. One card at a time. Escape collapses.
Job detail location	Inline or right-side drawer — NOT a separate route
Add Job button	Always reachable without scrolling — sticky or fixed
Search / filter / sort	Reserve UI space in Sprint 1. Wire up in Sprint 2.
Empty state	Encouraging prompt + direct CTA to add first job

3. Screen Boundaries

These are fixed. Do not move features between screens without team agreement.

Dashboard	Job cards, pipeline stages, activity, analytics. Primary workspace.
Profile	Everything about the candidate: name, bio, photo, contact, experience, education, skills, preferences.
Settings	Account controls only: theme, language, notifications, password, logout. No candidate data here.
Document Library	Global document management. Deferred to Sprint 3 — reserve the nav slot.

Rule: describes who the candidate is → Profile. Controls how the app behaves → Settings.

4. Mobile Constraints

Desktop-first. All complex workflows are optimized for desktop. Mobile must be usable — not identical.

Breakpoints	Desktop $\geq 1024\text{px}$ / Tablet $768\text{--}1023\text{px}$ / Mobile $< 768\text{px}$
Navigation	Sidebar → bottom tab bar at $< 768\text{px}$. Four icons only, no labels required.
Cards	Full-width stack on mobile. No multi-column layout below 768px .
Job detail	Full-screen sheet on mobile instead of inline/drawer expansion.
Minimum width	375px — must not break or overflow at this width.
Touch targets	Minimum $44\times 44\text{px}$ for all tappable elements.
PWA	Optional. Not required for any sprint.

Mobile support should be intentional, not an afterthought. Test at 375px before marking any story done.

5. Component Standards

Shared components — build once, use everywhere

- Button: variants Primary, Secondary, Ghost, Destructive. One primary action per section.
- Input: label above field always. Never placeholder-only. Error inline below field.
- JobCard: compact and expanded states. Stage badge colors per Section 6.
- Modal: max 560px . Close via X, Escape, backdrop. Primary action bottom-right.
- Toast: bottom-right. 4s auto-dismiss for success, persistent for errors.
- ErrorBoundary: wraps every page component. Shows friendly fallback, never raw errors.

File placement

components/	Reusable UI — kebab-case filenames (job-card.jsx, stage-badge.jsx)
pages/	Route-level views only — no business logic (dashboard-page.jsx)
services/	API calls only — one file per resource (jobs.service.js)
styles/	Global CSS and all token definitions (tokens.css)
hooks/	Custom React hooks (useJobList.js, useProfile.js)

CSS tokens must be defined in styles/tokens.css — not hardcoded inside component files.

6. Typography

Display font	DM Serif Display — page titles, major headings
Body font	Inter — all body text, labels, inputs, navigation
Mono font	JetBrains Mono — code and technical values only

sm 13px / 20px lh	Captions, timestamps, secondary labels
md 15px / 24px lh	Body text, inputs, nav items (default)
lg 18px / 28px lh	Card titles, section labels
xl 22px / 32px lh	Sub-page headings
2xl 28px / 36px lh	Page section headings
3xl 36px / 44px lh	Page titles

7. Color Tokens

All values defined as CSS variables in styles/tokens.css. Never use raw hex in component files.

Brand

	--color-primary	#1E4D8C Primary actions, active nav, focus rings
	--color-primary-light	#2E86AB Links, interactive affordances

	--color-primary-subtle	#EEF3FA <i>Hover states, badge backgrounds</i>
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Neutrals

	--color-text-primary	#1A1A2E <i>Primary body text</i>
	--color-text-secondary	#4A5568 <i>Secondary text, captions</i>
	--color-text-muted	#A0AEC0 <i>Placeholders, disabled text</i>
	--color-border	#CBD5E0 <i>All component borders</i>
	--color-surface	#F7FAFC <i>Page background</i>

Semantic

	--color-success	#38A169 <i>Confirmations, completed states</i>
	--color-error	#E53E3E <i>Errors, destructive actions, validation</i>
	--color-warning	#D69E2E <i>Warnings, soft deadlines</i>
	--color-info	#3182CE <i>Informational notices</i>

Pipeline Stage Badges — exact values, no deviation

Interested		bg #EBF8FF		text #2B6CB0
Applied		bg #EBF4FF		text #3730A3
Interview		bg #FEFCE8		text #854D0E
Offer		bg #F0FDF4		text #166534
Rejected		bg #FEF2F2		text #991B1B
Archived		bg #F9FAFB		text #6B7280

8. Spacing and Shape

8px base scale. All spacing must be a multiple of 4px.

xs 4px / sm 8px	Tight inline gaps, icon-to-text
md 16px	Component internal padding
lg 24px / xl 32px	Between components and sections
2xl 48px / 3xl 64px	Between page regions, outer padding

--radius-sm	4px — inputs, small badges
--radius-md	8px — cards, dropdowns, modals
--radius-pill	9999px — stage badge chips
--shadow-sm	0 1px 3px rgba(0,0,0,0.08) — card lift
--shadow-md	0 4px 12px rgba(0,0,0,0.10) — hover, dropdowns
--shadow-lg	0 8px 24px rgba(0,0,0,0.12) — modals

9. Definition of Done — UI Stories

A UI story is not mergeable unless every item below is true:

- **Navigation:** Sidebar present. Active state correct. No new top-level items added.
 - **Components:** Uses shared components only. No one-off local duplicates.
 - **Tokens:** No raw hex or px values in component files — CSS variables only.
 - **Stage badges:** Exact colors from Section 7. No deviations.
 - **Forms:** Label above every field. Error message inline below field.
 - **Async actions:** Loading state shown. Error handled — never raw error shown to user.
 - **Focus states:** Every interactive element has a visible focus ring.
 - **Mobile:** Tested at 375px. Does not break. Touch targets $\geq 44 \times 44$ px.
 - **Lint:** ESLint and Prettier pass. CI green before merge.
 - **File placement:** Component in correct folder. kebab-case filename.
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